the marine environment, as well as of assistance and salvage measures, so that appropria te action may be taken.

2.3.1 When required: The Plan should provide clear, concise guidance to enable the maste r to determine when a report to the coastal State is required.

2.3.1.1 Actual discharge: A report to the nearest coastal State is required whenever the re is: .

1 a discharge of oil, resulting from damage to the ship or its equipment, or for the pur pose of securing the safety of a ship or saving life at sea; or - whenever there is: .

1 a discharge of oil, resulting from damage to the ship or its equipment, or for the pur pose of securing the safety of a ship or saving life at sea; or .2 a discharge during th e operation of the ship of oil in excess of the quantity or instantaneous rate permitted under the present Convention.

2.3.1.2 Probable discharge: The Plan should give the master guidance to evaluate a situa tion which, though not involving an actual discharge, would qualify as a probable discha rge and thus require a report.

In jUdging whether there is such a probability and whether the report should be made, th e following factors, as a minimwn, should be taken into account: .1 the nature of the da mage, failure or breakdown of the ship, machinery or equipment; .

2 ship location and proximity to land or other navigational hazards; .

3 weather,